

Incident report analysis

Summary	The organization experienced a Denial of Service (DoS) attack, specifically an ICMP flood, which lasted for two hours. The attack compromised the internal network, causing network services to stop responding and preventing legitimate traffic from accessing resources. The cybersecurity team responded by blocking incoming ICMP packets and taking non-critical services offline to restore critical operations.
Identify	The incident management team audited the network and found the root cause: a misconfigured firewall that lacked rate limiting and source IP verification. This allowed a malicious actor to flood the network with spoofed ICMP packets, exhausting network bandwidth and causing a DoS condition. The affected systems included internal network services and resources accessed by employees.
Protect	To prevent future attacks, the network security team implemented several protective measures: • Added a new firewall rule to limit the rate of incoming ICMP packets. • Enabled source IP address verification on the firewall to check for spoofed IPs. • Implemented an Intrusion Prevention System (IPS) to actively filter out suspicious ICMP traffic based on attack signatures.
Detect	To detect potential future incidents, the team will rely on:

	• **Network monitoring software** to establish a baseline and alert analysts to abnormal traffic patterns (like sudden spikes in ICMP traffic). • The **IDS (Intrusion Detection System)** component, which will continuously monitor incoming traffic and generate alerts for suspicious activity.
Respond	During the incident, the team contained the attack by blocking incoming ICMP packets and offlining non-critical services. For future incidents, the team will follow an updated **Incident Response Playbook**. This includes immediate communication with upper management, isolating affected network segments to prevent lateral movement, and analyzing firewall and IDS logs to identify the attacker's origin.
Recover	The team successfully restored critical network services during the incident. To improve recovery for future events, the organization will implement a **Disaster Recovery Plan (DRP)**. This includes regular backups of network configurations (baseline configurations), ensuring critical services can fail over to redundant systems, and conducting post-incident reviews to update recovery procedures.

Reflections/Notes: